



M03: Making up new words

1. Pre-watching brainstorming:

1. With your table group, discuss potential reasons why new words are created or taken from another language. Use examples such as *kindergarten*, *schadenfreude*, *Brunch* (breakfast + lunch) or *Handy*.
2. Why might people use a word from another language in addition to a word that already exists, such as (in German) *Rendezvous* vs. *Date* vs. *Verabredung*?

2. While-watching note-taking: Watch the TED talk "[Go ahead, make up new words!](#)" by Erin McKean. Find the terms and short descriptions for the word-formation techniques mentioned in the video:

Example	Name of the process	Description: How the process works
ninja		
duckface		(not only possible with two nouns but also adjectives and verbs)
brunch		
to friend	(also called 'conversion')	
to burgle		
OMG		

3. Post-watching activity:

1. Find at least two further example for each of the word-formation processes in addition to the examples given in the video.
2. Make up at least one new word using every word-formation process from the video. It might be useful to think back to moments when you were struggling to find the right word (in an exam, in class, with friends, ...).
3. Discuss your results with your table group, discuss potential mistakes you or they might have made, and add their examples to your list.

Further examples

Own creations

Examples from other group members